

ENGLISH

This section contains 22 questions.

The time allotted is 20 minutes.

The following section contains three types of questions: Sentence Completion, Restatement and Reading Comprehension. Each question is followed by four possible responses. Choose the response which best answers the question and mark its number in the appropriate place on the answer sheet.

Sentence Completions (Questions 1-8)

This part consists of sentences with a word or words missing in each. For each question, choose the answer which best completes the sentence.

- The _____ "experimental science" was first used in the 13th century by the philosopher Roger Bacon.
 - term
 - section
 - task
 - signal
- It is said that men are four times more likely to be _____ by lightning than women are.
 - swept
 - sworn
 - struck
 - shrunk
- Nineteenth-century scientist Joseph Henry's greatest _____ to the field of physics was his work on electromagnetism.
 - extravagance
 - correspondence
 - exploitation
 - contribution
- A Zulu hut resembles a beehive in shape and is sometimes _____ for one from a distance.
 - mistaken
 - forgiven
 - worn
 - undone

5. Chile's Atacama Desert is the most _____ place on Earth, containing large stretches of land where no rainfall has ever been recorded.

- (1) placid
- (2) subtle
- (3) arid
- (4) idle

6. In 2009, a severe outbreak of late blight fungus _____ most of the tomato and potato crops on the east coast of the United States.

- (1) traded in
- (2) brushed off
- (3) wiped out
- (4) backed up

7. The Kermode bear is an _____ animal, rarely spotted even in its natural habitat.

- (1) amiable
- (2) elusive
- (3) indignant
- (4) oppressive

8. Governments _____ considerable funds to developing systems that can thwart cyber attacks on crucial industries.

- (1) formulate
- (2) escalate
- (3) allocate
- (4) contemplate

Restatements (Questions 9-12)
 This part consists of several sentences, each followed by four possible ways of restating the main idea of that sentence in different words. For each question, choose the one restatement which best expresses the meaning of the original sentence.

9. A person who is deficient in a particular nutrient may crave certain foods.
- (1) A strong desire for certain foods can be caused by the lack of a specific nutrient.
 - (2) Consuming an adequate amount of nutrients can promote good health.
 - (3) Cravings can lead to the excessive consumption of food.
 - (4) People tend to consume foods that have little nutritional value.
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10. In the first part of the twentieth century, sugar exports to the U.S. dominated the Cuban economy.
- (1) In the first part of the twentieth century, Cuba exported more sugar to the U.S. than to any other country.
 - (2) In the first part of the twentieth century, Cuba's chief export to the U.S. was sugar.
 - (3) In the first part of the twentieth century, the Cuban economy depended primarily on sugar exports to the U.S.
 - (4) In the first part of the twentieth century, sugar exports to the U.S. stimulated economic growth in Cuba.
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11. Angola is riddled with landmines, remnants of the country's civil war.
- (1) Landmines were used extensively in Angola during the civil war.
 - (2) Years after the civil war, Angola is still trying to remove the last of the many landmines placed there.
 - (3) Many Angolans were injured by landmines during the civil war.
 - (4) Landmines planted during Angola's civil war are scattered throughout the country.
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12. Harper Lee's *To Kill a Mockingbird* was published in 1960 to nearly unanimous critical acclaim.
- (1) The publication of Harper Lee's *To Kill a Mockingbird* generated furious public debate.
 - (2) Critics agree that *To Kill a Mockingbird*, published in 1960, was Harper Lee's best novel.
 - (3) Responses to Harper Lee's *To Kill a Mockingbird* ranged from enthusiastic to critical.
 - (4) At the time of its publication, Harper Lee's *To Kill a Mockingbird* was praised by the vast majority of critics.

Reading Comprehension

This part consists of two passages, each followed by several related questions. For each question, choose the most appropriate answer based on the text.

Text I (Questions 13-17)

- (1) On the streets of Mumbai, India, on any business day, some 5,000 men weave their way on foot or on bicycle through the city's dense traffic, each carrying 30 or more metal lunch boxes. These lunch boxes are called *dabbas* and the men who transport them are known as *dabbawalas*. A *dabba* has two, three, or four tiers, each of which contains one element of a meal: rice, curried vegetables, *naan* bread etc. Every day, *dabbawalas* deliver almost 200,000 home-cooked lunches from people's homes to their places of employment in the city.

- (10) The *dabbawala* network started in 1890, when a Mumbai banker decided he wanted a meal cooked in his own kitchen to be delivered to his office at lunchtime. He hired the first ever *dabbawala*, Mahadeo Havaji Bachche, to bring the meal to him. The banker's co-workers, envious of his freshly cooked, promptly delivered lunches, soon requested Bachche's services as well. Unable to keep up with demand, Bachche enlisted his friends and relatives to assist in deliveries. The idea caught on from there.

- (15) Today the *dabbawalas* have a well-oiled system. In mid-morning, they pick up *dabbas* from their customers' homes. The *dabbas* are labeled using hand-painted symbols and colors to denote the address to which each *dabba* is to be delivered and to which it should be returned. Each *dabbawala* takes his boxes to the nearest train station, where they are sorted and loaded onto trains according to their destination. When they arrive, the *dabbas* are unloaded, sorted again, and assigned to another *dabbawala*, who delivers them to the customers in time for lunch. After lunchtime, the *dabbawalas* reverse the process, picking up the empty *dabbas* and bringing them back to customers' homes.

- (25) Despite their old-fashioned methods, the *dabbawalas* can teach high-tech delivery services a thing or two. They seldom fail to deliver a meal on time. According to a 2010 study by Harvard Business School, the *dabbawalas* make fewer than 3.4 errors per million transactions. It is no wonder, then, that executives from industry giants such as Amazon and FedEx have spent time studying the secrets of the *dabbawalas*' success.

Questions

13. The main purpose of the text is to discuss _____ Mumbai.

- (1) a remarkable food delivery network in
(2) the traditional food culture of
(3) the complex transportation system of
(4) business opportunities in

14. According to the first paragraph, dabbas -

- (1) were invented in India
- (2) are used for three meals each day
- (3) keep parts of a meal separate
- (4) are difficult to carry

15. In line 12, "to keep up with demand" could best be restated as -

- (1) to supply his growing number of customers
- (2) to find another job
- (3) to remain in Mumbai
- (4) to serve people lunch in their homes

16. According to the third paragraph, which of the following best summarizes the process of delivering a dabba?

- (1) the dabba is picked up from the customer's home → the dabba is taken to a train station → the dabba is filled with food and marked → the dabba is delivered to the customer's workplace
- (2) the dabba is picked up from the customer's home → the dabba is taken to a train station → the dabba is sent by train to a different station → the dabba is delivered to the customer's workplace
- (3) the dabba is picked up from the customer's home → the dabba is taken to a train station → the dabba is collected by the customer → the customer takes the dabba to his workplace
- (4) the dabba is picked up from the customer's home → the dabba is transported by train → the dabba is unloaded and filled with freshly cooked food → the customer takes the dabba to his workplace

17. The main purpose of the last paragraph is to -

- (1) explain how the dabbawalas could improve their methods
- (2) present the results of a study on the dabbawalas
- (3) show how successful the dabbawala system is
- (4) compare the dabbawala system with those of industry giants

שאלה
Text II (Questions 18-22)

- (1) The lemming is a type of rodent indigenous to the Arctic. Lemmings are famous for their cyclical population explosions – sharp increases in birthrate that recur approximately every four years. At the height of these population explosions, the lemmings, apparently driven by deep-rooted impulses, run off cliffs by the thousands, to be dashed to their deaths on the rocks below. This allegedly suicidal behavior has become a metaphor for the actions of large crowds of people who mindlessly follow one another, heedless of the consequences.

- (10) It is now known, however, that lemmings do not actually commit mass suicide. Rather, when their population increases drastically, overcrowding and food depletion compel the lemmings to migrate to less densely populated areas. Unfortunately, the geographic features of the Arctic are such that the migrating lemmings often find themselves channeled into narrow mountain passes. The lemmings feel trapped in the confined space and experience social friction and distress. Mass panic ensues, with lemmings fleeing in all possible directions and sometimes falling off cliffs.

- (15) It was the 1958 Disney Studios film *White Wilderness* that popularized the misconception of the "lemming suicide plunge". The filmmakers staged a plunge-to-the-death sequence by herding lemmings over a cliff and into a river. Evidently, they considered the lives of a few dozen rodents worth sacrificing for the sake of exciting footage.

שאלה
Questions

18. In line 5, the word "allegedly" is used to -

- (1) cast doubt on the suicidal nature of the lemmings' behavior
- (2) emphasize the similarity between lemmings and humans
- (3) differentiate between lemming behavior before and after population explosions
- (4) illustrate the long-term effects of lemming mass suicide

19. The main purpose of the second paragraph is to -

- (1) list the social factors governing lemming migration
- (2) discuss the periodic fluctuations in lemming populations
- (3) explain why lemmings fall to their deaths
- (4) describe the migration routes of lemmings

20. According to the second paragraph, the geographic features of the Arctic -

- (1) compel lemmings to migrate in search of food
- (2) give rise to situations in which lemmings panic
- (3) make the lemming population prone to overcrowding
- (4) are responsible for drastic increases in the lemming population

21. According to the last paragraph, the makers of White Wilderness -

- (1) documented an actual "lemming suicide plunge"
- (2) forced lemmings over a cliff
- (3) disproved a popular misconception
- (4) made several films about lemmings

22. An appropriate title for this text would be -

- (1) Lemming Suicide: Fact or Fiction?
- (2) Lemming Migration Patterns
- (3) The Mundane Life of the Lemming
- (4) Suicidal Behavior in the Wild